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goods and distributes different brands and variety of the particular line. For example, a wholesaler may deal in refrigerators produced by different manufacturer.

c. **Speciality Wholesalers:** This wholesaler specialises in a single product. For example, a wholesaler may deal only in Tata tea and nothing else.

23.08 Retail trade - Meaning

Retail trade is a trade that deals with the distribution of goods in small quantities to the end consumers. The retails represent the final stage in the distribution where goods are transferred from the hands of manufacturers or wholesalers to the final consumers or users. If the sales are made directly to the end consumers it will be considered as retailing. Retail trade performs different functions in the distribution of goods and services, purchasing of variety of products, arranging proper storages and selling the goods in small quantities and so on.



Definition

According to S. Evelyn Thomas "*the retailer is the last of the many links in the economic chain whereby the consumer's wants are satisfied smoothly and efficiently by retailers*".

According to Cundiff and Still "*a retailer is a merchant or occasionally an agent whose main business is selling directly to the ultimate consumers*".

A retailer has been defined as "a trading intermediary engaged in the distribution of goods to the ultimate consumer".



23.09 Characteristics of Retailers

Following are the characteristics of retail traders

1. Retailer generally involves dealing in a variety of items. A retailer makes purchases from producers or wholesalers in bulk for sale to the end consumers in small quantities.
2. Retail trade is normally carried on in or near the main market area.
3. Generally, retailers involve buying on credit from wholesalers and selling for cash to consumers.
4. A retailer has indirect relation with the manufacturer (through wholesalers) but a direct link with the consumers.